

Communication Skills

LA10760

- 
- A photograph of a lecture hall. In the center, a large screen displays a presentation slide with a blue line at the top and two numbered points. To the left, a whiteboard is partially visible. To the right, there is a chair with a backpack on it and a small black cabinet. The walls are covered in wood paneling, and the floor is a light-colored wooden table in the foreground.
1. Communication process
 2. The use of language in effective communication

Effective Persuasion

"Persuasive writing seeks to convince its readers to embrace the point-of-view presented by appealing to the audience's reason and understanding through argument".

- Purdue University Writing Lab

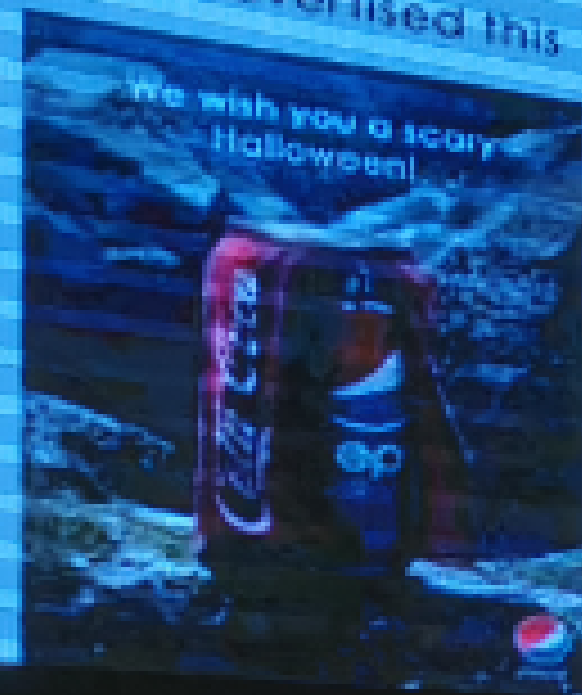
1. Understand your audience - (Collect ideas)
 2. Find common ground with your audience - (Burkean Parlor)
 3. Know the various sides of your issue and respectfully address other points of view - (Literature Review)
 4. Establish your argument - (thesis statement and progression of the argument)
-

Types of sentences

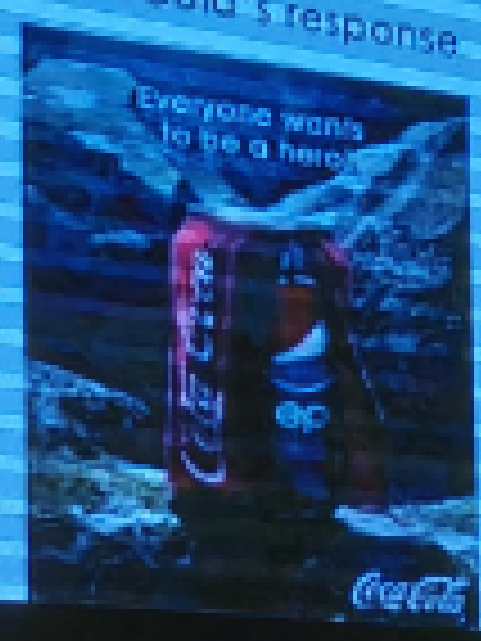
1. Writerly
2. Readerly

Why care about communication skills?

Pepsi advertised this



CocaCola's response



With the beginning of the new '80s, it is readily ascertainable that there has been little if any improvement in the overall national or general local economy. It is expected by some economists that a general upturn on the national level should come about sometime during mid-1981. However, with the increase in taxes starting in January, mainly an increase in social security, this will reduce the amount of free funds available for the stimulation of consumer spending.

With the beginning of the '80s, there is little improvement in the local or national economy. Although some economists expect an upturn in mid-1981, the increase in social security taxes scheduled for January may reduce available funds for consumer spending.

In 1980 we saw little if any improvement in the economy, national or local, and although some economists expect an upturn in mid-1981, the tax increases scheduled to begin in January, mainly for social security, will leave consumers with less money to spend.

Be clear and concise

Profile of a wordy sentence

Passive voice

Weak verbs

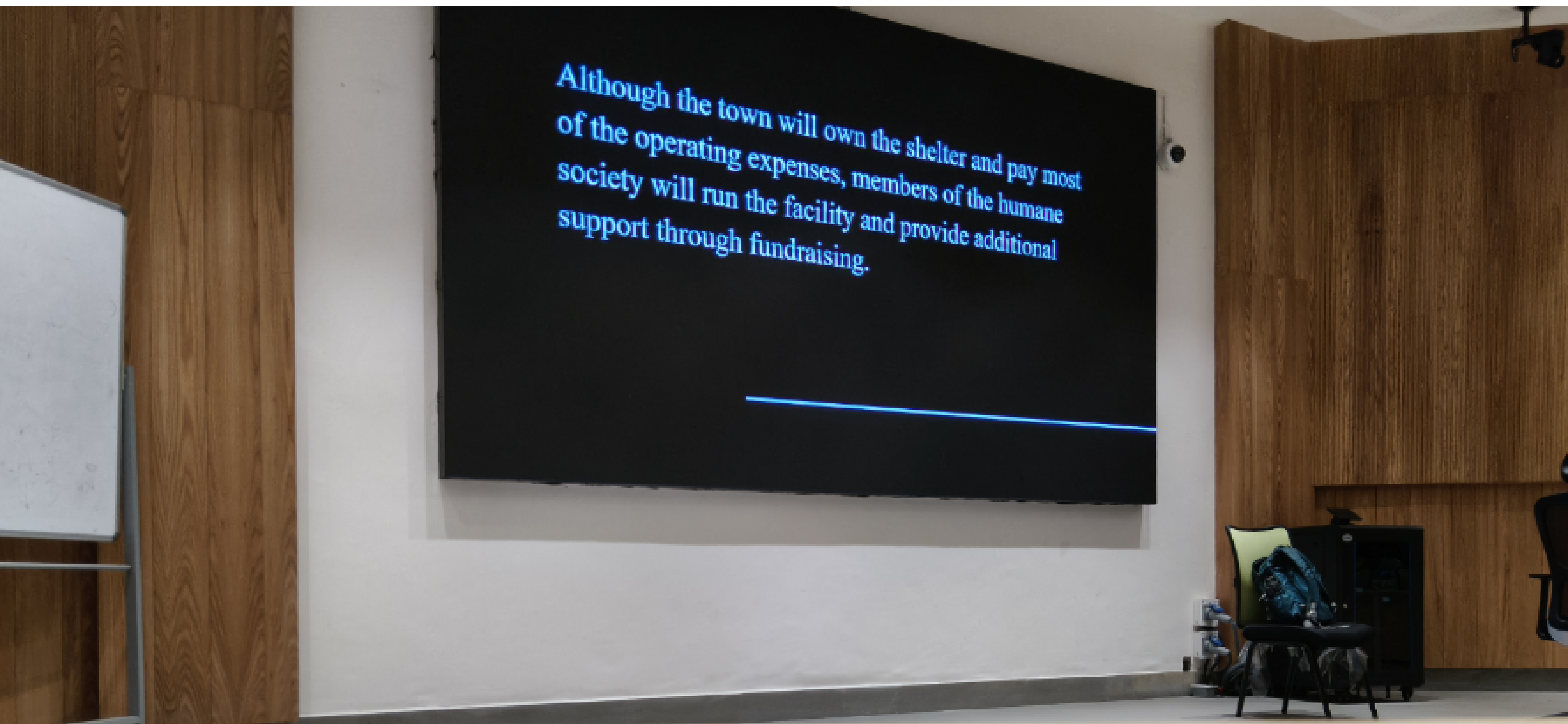
Bulky nouns

Line by Line: How to Edit Your Own Writing (1985) by Claire Kehrwald Cook

Passive Voice

The shelter will be owned by the town, but it will be run by members of the humane society and supported, in part, by funds raised by them. The bulk of the operating funds, however, will be supplied by the town.

Although the town will own the shelter and pay most of the operating expenses, members of the humane society will run the facility and provide additional support through fundraising.



Weak Verbs

Verb *to be*:

Means to exist (I *am* here),

to occur (The deadline *is* today),

to have the characteristic of something (She *was* sick)

am, are, is, was, were, being, been.

Actionless verbs:

have, exist

Passive form: is believed, was seen

More remote, less densely populated suburbs, whose lower values were often a function of how far they were from work centers, and small towns in rural locations, whose lower values were a reflection of the difficulty of earning a living, are likely to see considerable appreciation of their property values in the next two decades.

Since many people will no longer have to commute to work centers to earn a living, property values in the more distant suburbs and rural areas should appreciate considerably in the next two decades.

Condensation

An active verb often replaces a noun or an adjective sandwiched between a weak verb and a preposition.

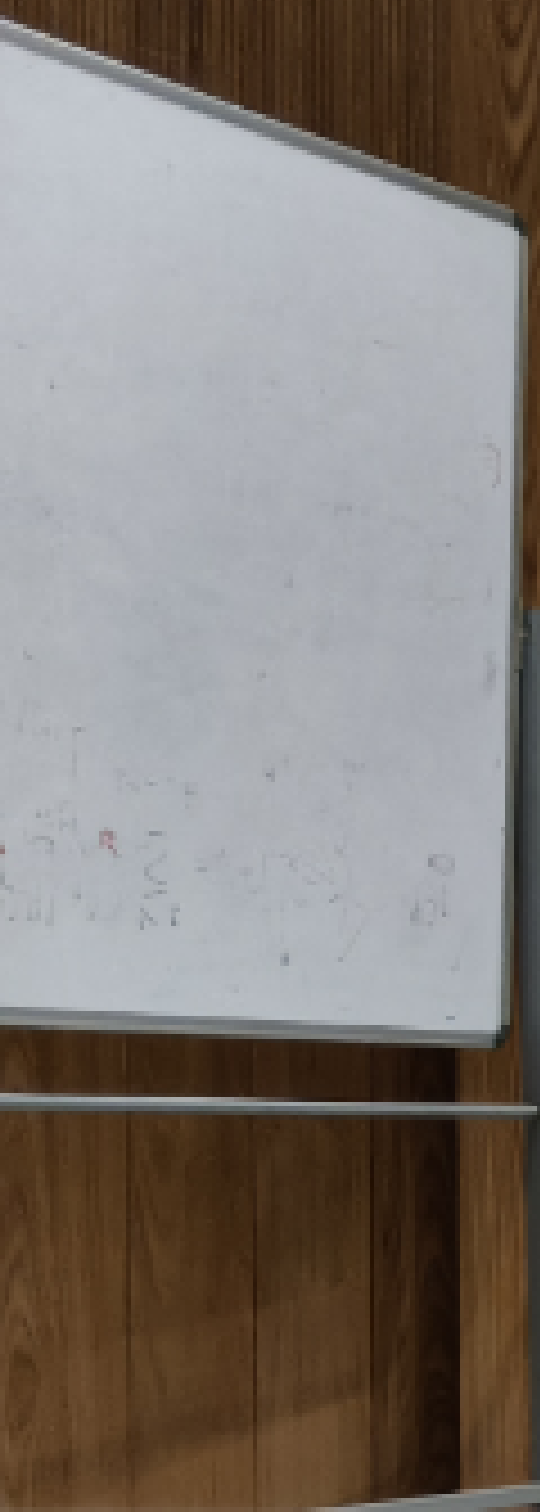
- is indicative of → *indicates*
- have an influence on → *influence*
- make an assessment of → *assess*
- is capable of → *can*
- is of interest to → *interests*

Bulky Nouns

Nouns ending with
-tion, -ment, -ence

The inference that because high school graduates are more likely to be employed than dropouts, the differences may be attributed to the possession of a diploma is suspect since dropouts and graduates may differ in a variety of ways relevant to both graduation prospects and employment status.

It is not necessarily the diploma that makes high school graduates more employable than dropouts; other differences may affect both their education and their job prospects.



Convert it back to verbs

Condensation

by the implementation of $\rightarrow$ by *implementing*

in the creation of $\rightarrow$ in *creating*

in the discussion of $\rightarrow$ in *discussing*

through the examination of $\rightarrow$ through *examining*

by the addition of $\rightarrow$ by *adding*